

3.61 million

The 3DS is doing well with 3.61 million devices being sold contrasting with the sale of Wii which is down to 15 million from 20 million last year

New radio wave technique

Scientists at the University of Leicester have discovered a new technique to detect alien planets by looking at radio waves emitted by ultraviolet flares on planets

Bazaar

Canon S95

Low-light performer with RAW support

The Canon Powershot S95 is an advanced compact point-and-shoot digital camera, promising to offer great low-light shooting and a host of manual controls. The key differentiators for the Canon S95 lay in the 10MP CCD image sensor and the lens that it incorporates. With a sensor size of 1/1.7 inch vs the standard sensor size of 1/2.5 inch found in most other compact digital cameras, the Powershot S95 has a clear edge in terms of image quality. Coupled with the larger sensor is a bright F2.0, 28-105 mm lens. Here again, with the lens aperture being F2.0 at 28 mm, the S95 promises faster performance in low-light situations.

The S95 is fairly loaded with



features such as wide angle lens (28 mm), HD video recording at 24 fps, hybrid image stabilisation, RAW shooting mode, a 3.0-inch LCD, HDMI connectivity and a control ring to toggle settings such as ISO, shutter speed and aperture. It does miss out on some of the latest features like geo-tagging and wireless controls. Usability and design is one of its strengths, with a metal body and robust, high-quality construction, the S95 feels very secure and solid. The interface and controls are

well implemented, ensuring flexibility and intuitive operation across all shooting modes. In our performance tests, the Canon S95 did a commendable job with crisp images along with accurate colour saturation in most test scenes. The biggest advantage was seen in low-light shooting, ISO400 shots had minimal noise and we were even able to capture fairly good images at ISO800 with very little noise.

So, is the Canon S95 a good buy? Yes, especially if you are looking for a compact point-and-shoot that will not falter in low-light and offer full manual mode with RAW support. What comes in the way of what is otherwise an excellent product, is its price tag - the Canon S95 is over-priced.

Sobam Raninga

Specifications

Sensor: 10.4 megapixels
ISO range: 80 - 3200
Screen: 3.0 inch,
461000 pixels
Optical zoom: 3.8x
Video recording: HD
1280x720@24fps

Contact

Canon India Private Limited

Phone: 1800-345-33-66

Email: info@canon.co.in

Web site: www.canon.co.in

Price: ₹26,995

7.5
10

Features.....	8.0
Performance.....	8.0
Build.....	8.5
Value for money	5.0

Specifications

12.3MP CMOS sensor;
ISO Range:100 to 6400;
Image stabilization; CF/
DC dual slot; Battery: 1620
BLM-5 Lithium ion

Contact

Olympus Imaging India Pvt.

Ltd.

Email: srivastava_kriti@
olympus.in

Web site: www.olympus-
imaging.co.in

Price: ₹84,995

Warranty: 2 years

6.5
10

Features.....	7.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	7.5
Value for money	6.0

Olympus E-5

12.3 MP Four-Thirds DSLR camera

Solidly built, the E-5 has a good grip and feel, also borrows some electronic features from its smaller Micro Four Thirds brethren.

It delivers great image quality in good light, especially at high ISO settings. Images have good contrast, low noise and spot-on colour accuracy, with AWB up to the task under most conditions. Above ISO 800 however, sharpness and noise levels suffer in low light, and above ISO 1600, fine details suffer. Some highlight clipping also occurs in high-contrast scenes, avoidable if using RAW format. Default sharpness is a bit soft,

however, this can be adjusted in the menu. Video quality (720p) is also good, with good sharpness and colour accuracy, fast AF, as well as no jerks.

Continuous drive is not up to the mark, with variable 5 fps not good enough. The AF system is very fast though.

Its 1620 mAh BLM-5 battery life is quite solid, rated to last up to 870 shots. The menus and control system are far from perfect, and much fewer options are available compared to other DSLRs in this price category.



At its price range, the Olympus E-5 has superior competition in the form

of the Nikon D7000 and the Canon EOS 7D, which are more versatile cameras, but in terms of specifications, the E-5 is probably closer to the D300s and the Canon EOS 50D. As for performance and price, the E-5 doesn't compare well with its competitors, but is a solid upgrade from the Olympus E3 or E1, especially if you have a Zuiko Digital lens with you.

Abhinav Lal